

Settlement Exception Investigation and Resolution

SOP ID	SOP-SET-001	Version	1.0
Status	ACTIVE	Effective Date	2026-01-01
Parent Policy	POL-SET-001	Business Unit	SETTLEMENTS
Classification	INTERNAL CONFIDENTIAL	Access Scope	ROLE_BASED

1. Preconditions

Confirm user authorization, account or case scope, applicable policy version, source-system availability, and any market cutoff or SLA constraints.

Control checkpoint: log the action and preserve enough evidence for an independent reviewer to reproduce the decision.

2. Step-by-Step Procedure

Retrieve the relevant operational record through the approved governed interface. Validate identifiers. Compare live state with the applicable policy. Record evidence before taking or recommending action.

Control checkpoint: log the action and preserve enough evidence for an independent reviewer to reproduce the decision.

3. Exception Handling

If required evidence is missing, policy versions conflict, tool access fails, or the case is high risk, stop automated recommendation and route to the designated human queue.

Control checkpoint: log the action and preserve enough evidence for an independent reviewer to reproduce the decision.

4. Data Handling

Use only the minimum necessary customer information. Mask direct identifiers in prompts, traces, analytics, and test environments unless explicitly approved for the task.

Control checkpoint: log the action and preserve enough evidence for an independent reviewer to reproduce the decision.

5. Closure

Record outcome, reason code, policy reference, live-system reference, user identity, timestamps, checker approval where required, and any follow-up action.

Control checkpoint: log the action and preserve enough evidence for an independent reviewer to reproduce the decision.

Operational Checklist

Step	Control
1	Authenticate user and determine role / access scope.
2	Validate request identifiers and normalize the task.
3	Retrieve current policy guidance and confirm effective version.
4	Use approved MCP tool for live operational data when needed.
5	Compare evidence, detect conflicts, and calculate SLA / materiality rules.
6	Apply maker-checker or human escalation requirements.
7	Generate response with citations and source references.
8	Apply output masking, audit logging, and safe observability redaction.

Failure and Escalation Scenarios

- MCP authorization denied: do not retry with broader privileges; return a controlled access response and log the denied attempt.
- Current policy cannot be established: do not use a superseded or future policy as a substitute; route to Policy Control.
- Live record and cached response disagree: bypass cache and refresh from authorized source systems.
- PII detected in free text: mask before LLM/tracing unless an approved use requires the value.
- Low confidence or conflicting evidence: generate a concise evidence summary and route to human review.